

Brian W. Smith

PRINCIPAL SITE RELIABILITY ENGINEER · AWS & KUBERNETES · CLOUD-NATIVE INFRASTRUCTURE

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25+ YEARS IN PRODUCTION	100+ PRODUCTION K8S CLUSTERS OPERATED	Multi-Region AWS ARCHITECTURES	AI-Enabled INFRA AUTOMATION TOOLS
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SUMMARY

Principal SRE at Red Hat with 25+ years of enterprise infrastructure experience, specializing in cloud-native platform engineering, building automated multi-region AWS platforms, and reliability at scale. Deep expertise in OpenShift/Kubernetes (EKS), AWS multi-account architectures, GitOps workflows, and Terraform IaC at scale. Proven track record of owning production systems end-to-end, debugging complex stateful systems, and reducing operational load through safe, self-healing automation. Currently architecting AI-powered base-level infra services and reliability tooling for enterprise clusters.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

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|-------------------------------|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| ▶ Kubernetes (EKS/OCP) / CKA | ▶ AWS Multi-Account / Networking | ▶ Terraform / GitOps (ArgoCD) |
| ▶ Stateful Systems Operations | ▶ Python / Bash / Go | ▶ Splunk / Dynatrace / Grafana |
| ▶ Linux Systems & Performance | ▶ CI/CD (GitHub Actions, GitLab) | ▶ Keycloak / IAM / SSO |
| ▶ Claude AI / Agent SDK / MCP | ▶ Incident Response / On-call | ▶ Multi-region Infrastructure |

EXPERIENCE

Red Hat

November 2021 – Present

PRINCIPAL SRE · PRINCIPAL SRE TEAM LEAD · SENIOR SRE – ROSA REGIONAL PLATFORM

Principal SRE (January 2026 – Present) · Principal SRE Team Lead (January 2025 – January 2026)

- Operate and scale multi-region AWS platforms supporting hundreds of production Kubernetes clusters; design and maintain robust Terraform modules with automated plan-on-PR / apply-on-merge GitOps pipelines.
- Architect AWS PrivateLink and multi-account connectivity for Hosted Control Planes (HCP) across all regions, establishing secure organizational boundaries, IAM configurations, and network isolation.
- Lead the reduction of operational toil by identifying repeat pain points and deploying compliance-monkey across management clusters to automate self-healing and continuous security auditing.
- Built AI agent-enabled base-level infra services, including a fully automated audit system (Claude Sonnet sub-agent) evaluating infrastructure state across repositories, producing Jira tickets, GitHub PRs, and execution reports.
- Architect and deploy Thanos, Dynatrace, and Grafana observability suites via IaC to monitor petabytes of data, enabling deep performance reasoning and debugging of complex stateful systems.
- Validated compliance and performance profiles for OpenShift on EKS, ensuring high availability, scalable node provisioning, and robust networking at scale.

Senior SRE Functional Lead (December 2023 – January 2025) · Senior SRE (November 2021 – December 2023)

- Led a team of 9 SREs building a greenfield highly-available cloud platform on AWS; owned complex systems end-to-end, handling on-call rotations, incident response, and driving continuous operational improvements.
- Managed multi-account AWS deployments, championing Transit Gateway hub-and-spoke topologies, VPC Flow Logs, and robust global stateful architectures to balance consistency and availability.
- Deployed and supported stateful identity systems (Red Hat build of Keycloak) to production, scaling infrastructure to handle heavy traffic and implementing real-time synthetic availability monitoring.
- Automated AWS organizational scaling and security using Terraform at scale, mitigating tech debt and reducing deployment risks through continuous integration and safe release patterns.

Fiserv

March 2017 – November 2021

SENIOR SYSTEM ENGINEER LEAD – CLOUD PLATFORM

- Designed and built 16 Pivotal Cloud Foundry foundations supporting 7,000+ microservices; designed and implemented Kubernetes solution into Azure using Pivotal Kubernetes Service (PKS/TKGI).
- Led the PaaS deployment of a Fiserv presence into Azure; presented at SpringOne 2019 on hybrid-cloud Terraform architecture. Authored Terraform solution for Azure enterprise infrastructure.
- Built a self-service Kubernetes cluster provisioning platform (web form → Git → pipeline → Helm-deployed Prometheus/Grafana stack + expiration cleanup); designed centralized SLI dashboards across 14 PAS foundations using Grafana, AlertManager, and Prometheus.
- Achieved Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA-2000-008308-0100) certification; formed and trained the Cloud Platform team using agile methodologies.

OneStream Software

February 2021 – November 2021

FIRST DEVOPS ENGINEER

- Migrated 70+ repositories from TFS to Azure DevOps; implemented SonarQube SAST scanning, GitFlow branch strategy, and Azure Pipelines CI/CD as the organization's founding DevOps engineer.

Grange Insurance

2006 – 2017 (with gap 2008)

SENIOR SYSTEM ENGINEER – EXCHANGE / ACTIVE DIRECTORY / MESSAGING

- Migrated 3,000 on-premise Exchange 2013 mailboxes to O365; administered 9-server Exchange 2003/2007/2013 environment; architected AD, ADFS, PKI, KMS, PeopleSoft GL integrations, and enterprise FTP platform.
- Built PowerShell and VB automation tooling including a New User Tool, nested AD group reporting, AD photo import pipeline, and SharePoint offboarding automation.

Earlier Roles

1998 - 2008

NETJETS (SR. NETWORK ADMIN) • BMW FINANCIAL (CRM ADMIN) • CARDINAL HEALTH (SR. MESSAGING ENGINEER) • WD PARTNERS (IT ADMIN)

– 25+ years of progressive infrastructure experience spanning messaging, networking, virtualisation, enterprise AD/Exchange, and automation — from first ISP support role (BellSouth.net) through senior engineering leadership.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA)	CKA-2000-008308-0100
Azure DevOps Engineer Expert (AZ-400)	December 2020
Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-303/304)	October 2020
Azure Administrator Associate (AZ-104)	October 2020

EDUCATION & NOTABLE

Franklin University — Computer Science	Columbus, OH
Eagle Scout — Boy Scouts of America	Order of the Arrow
SpringOne 2019 Speaker	Pivotal Platform / Azure
Open Source Contributor	github.com/theautoroboto